

One level of sophistication yet remains. Here you need inside information to decode the name. FISH, for example, represents Small's Oilfield Services; the company rents oil tools that *fish* for junk stuck in the drill pipe. CHAI is Hebrew for "life," now the toast of Life Medical Services. Exide Electronics makes uninterruptible power supply units, so its ticker is XUPS.

Cute can get too cute. Glacier Water couldn't use WATR (Tetra-Tech has it), so they tried for H₂O. They adopted HOO. Nice try, bad chemistry.

Hot Hands, Cool Heads

There's another aspect to professionalism. A professional must try to keep emotion out of what he does. Emotion is marvelous in poetry or on TV or in the bedroom, but you don't particularly want it in high-risk situations. You don't want to fly behind an emotional airline pilot, you don't want to be operated on by an emotional cardiac surgeon. You want someone who stays cool, especially when the unexpected happens.

I don't claim professional portfolio managers are immune to emotional responses to five-hundred-point drops in the Dow Industrials or don't get attached to favorite stocks, but I do believe they are more objective than most individual investors. They are less likely to panic in bear markets and more likely to be skeptical in boom times. On the whole, they are readier to admit mistakes and take losses. They are inundated daily with contrary views, which fosters objectivity. They are, in short, more rational when tough decisions have to be made. Also, they understand the seriousness of